

# The moral dilemma of AI powered by nuclear energy

Posted by u/Far-Definition-7971 • • 0 points • 6 comments

I recently learned something that I am having trouble settling my mind on. AI systems are increasingly being powered by nuclear power. Specifically, (names like Bill Gates ) investing in nuclear reactors to support the demand and infrastructure of AI.

I understand AI requires enormous amounts of energy and nuclear power is low-carbon compared to fossil fuels but when I looked into it deeper, the moral dilemmas started to weigh on me.

Obviously we are all aware of the risks - the unavoidable waste from nuclear is a threat to the planet for thousands of years, even before taking into account the possibilities of another Chernobyl or Fukushima disaster.

I feel disappointed and even betrayed in a way!

I've been a big believer in AI's potential to help humanity. Knowing it's tied to energy solutions that could ultimately cause harm makes me question the entire system.

A deeper issue for me - by using AI and funding it through subscriptions, am I contributing to this system becoming Nuclear? It feels like no matter where I turn I'm feeding into corporations and systems that prioritize short-term solutions over long-term sustainability. How do you personally reconcile the benefits of AI with the potential costs to humanity and the environment?

This topic has left me torn and I'm hoping to open a thoughtful, respectful discussion about it.

Are there ways we to push for change and pressure big names to invest in renewable systems for AI?

## Comments

u/Ihaveamodel3 • 2 points • 2024-12-22 05:37 UTC

Nuclear is probably the cleanest and best form of electricity for our planet.

**u/hockey\_psychedelic** • 2 points • 2024-12-22 00:33 UTC

Check out the data centers in space initiatives.

**u/GhostInThePudding** • 0 points • 2024-12-21 23:34 UTC

Well, the alternative is to cover the entire planet in solar panels and wind generators and still not have enough power, because those technologies suck.

**u/Biggy\_Mancer** • 1 points • 2024-12-22 04:57 UTC

Not really. You could power the entire USA (including converting all vehicles to EV) if you covered 2% of the surface with solar panels. Most of these would be rooftops and parking garages. Further north we'd need more wind, and in general a mixed grid is a healthy grid.

That said I don't know if we have enough resources in the world to do this.

**u/Far-Definition-7971** • 1 points • 2024-12-21 23:57 UTC

And if enough pressure was put on the corporations responsible for investing that they had no option but to fund advancement in renewables- do you think it would still suck then? Cause nuclear radiation poisoning of the planet and people is way suckier, no?

**u/AutoModerator** • 1 points • 2024-12-21 23:11 UTC

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